

found "condensed into a drop of grammar" (II, xi, p. 222). A grammatical reference functions "not to give information about a state of affairs but to elucidate the logical grammar of a concept" (p. 386). A grammatical remark, then, is directed at the scaffolding of our thinking; it does not convey new information, but it makes possible a new way of seeing in which new information can be found. Such remarks are "hermeneutical" in that they *enable* understanding, indeed a new understanding of things. They bring "an advance in understanding" which "extends the horizon of the reader" (p. 388).

Frankly, the reviewer began the book with some skepticism despite the glowing tributes on the jacket: John Macquarrie asserting that it was "the most comprehensive discussion of the hermeneutical question I have ever read," F. F. Torrance saying "I have found this work to be an education to myself," and F. Torrance's "an admirable survey . . . a first-class account." There was a tribute from a philosopher? Would Thiselton be equal to the thinking of Heidegger, Gadamer, and Wittgenstein? Why do we have to use "philosophical description" in his very title, as if hermeneutics did not call into question the kind of attitude such a phrase suggests? But Thiselton's expository treatments of Heidegger, Gadamer, and Wittgenstein, while somewhat eclectic and uncritical in their use of the secondary literature on Heidegger, are patient, detailed, thorough, and lucid. Even when one has to disagree with Thiselton, one can see the basis for Thiselton's claims. As Thiselton is able to weave together more and more issues and texts in philosophical hermeneutics and twentieth century currents of New Testament interpretation, the reviewer reads on with growing enthusiasm. Thiselton puts together so many things that needed to be explicitly related, he argues so persuasively for the legitimacy and necessity of philosophical hermeneutics, and he discusses so many interpretive issues with a thoroughness that is both illuminating and helpful as a guide to further reading, one can be sure that *The Two Horizons* will be welcomed by scholars, teachers, and students alike as a work long needed on the subject.—R.E.P.

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VATTIMO, G. *Le avventure della differenza: Che cosa significa pensare dopo Nietzsche e Heidegger*. Milan: Garzanti, 1980. 203 pp. Lire 7,500—Gianni Vattimo is the author of a number of books, among which the best known are *Poesia e ontologia* (1967), *Introduzione a Heidegger* (1971), and *Il soggetto e la maschera* (1979). Considered to be the leading Italian critic of Nietzsche and Heidegger, he has now published a new collection of essays that promises to hold great interest for Anglo-Saxon readers. In translation the title and subtitle

would read: *The Adventures of Difference: What Thinking Means After Nietzsche and Heidegger*.

Having long been treated with academic dispassion by proponents of the analytic tradition in Anglo-American philosophy, Nietzsche and Heidegger are now being read with a new eye. This is largely due to the influence of French intellectuals. Interest in such writers as Jacques Derrida and Roland Barthes, Michel Foucault and Jacques Lacan has brought with it an inevitable recognition of the thinkers who have influenced the methodological innovations of these Frenchmen. More specifically, we have come to be aware of a new European movement that attempts to fuse the thought of Heidegger and Nietzsche. There is the school of Derrida, including Sarah Kofman, Gilles Deleuze, Jean Michel Rey, and Bernard Pautrat, as well as an Italian movement including Vattimo, Cacciari, and some leading poets.

The orientation of this movement may be called post-existentialist. Unlike an earlier view of Nietzsche and Heidegger, which linked them to Sartre, Camus, and Kierkegaard as philosophers of human resolution in an absurd world, the new reading picks up on their epistemic-ontological discoveries. It is this emphasis that brings such names as Wittgenstein, Chomsky, and Dilthey into the work of critics like Vattimo. It also explains the new interest in the Germans among English readers, for Nietzsche and Heidegger are now seen to be addressing issues pertaining to the very foundations of analytic philosophy: the search for the "how" of meaning or for the principles of understanding.

In the overview of the seven essays that is his introduction, Vattimo indeed claims that "much more than any other thinker present in our cultural horizon, Nietzsche and Heidegger have in a substantial way modified the very notion of thinking" (p. 5). The new thinking has been baptized "difference." The term, which will be familiar to us from the writings of Derrida (*L'écriture et la différence* and "La différence" in *Marges de la philosophie*), is Heidegger's. He sums up its meaning in the following lines: "Ontic truth and ontological truth regard the entity in its being and the being of the entity respectively. They co-penetrate each other in an essential way on the basis of their relation with the difference between being and entity (ontological difference). The essence of truth—which . . . bifurcates itself into ontic and ontological—is . . . possible only along with the opening up of this difference" (from *Vom Wesen des Grundes*, 1929; Vattimo, p. 73).

Vattimo soundly criticizes the school of Derrida for forgetting the problematical and "eventual" (or temporal) character of Heidegger's difference (or how and why entity and being become separated). Instead, Vattimo argues, they make difference itself into an ontological archistrukture (as the "Dionysian" fracturedness of being). Vattimo wants to take the argument back to Heidegger to move it into a new direction. Seeing modern thought, or what Heidegger called the epoch of the end of metaphysics (and that means Nietzsche), as having as its essential task to be mindful of this problem of difference, Vattimo speculates on what issues such a thought may have. (Needless to say, Vattimo's point of departure, like that of all Nietzschean Hei-

deggerians, involves a reversal of Heidegger's judgement on Nietzsche. Instead of locating Nietzsche at the very end of the metaphysical tradition—which is metaphysical precisely because it has forgotten the event of difference—they place Nietzsche alongside Heidegger as a pioneer of difference.)

Spanning seven years, Vattimo's essays raise a number of issues in differing ways which he aptly calls "the adventures of difference." Central to his meditations on difference is the "radical disorganization" of the subject (whom, with characteristic eloquence, he terms a "dividuum"), the "destructuring" tendency of Nietzsche's will to power as art (in contrast to Heidegger's metaphysical and formalistic interpretation of the same), the temporality, groundlessness, (*sfondamento*) and finitude of being, and the necessary conjunction of Heidegger's *Andenken* with *Ge-Stell*.

One must admit that Vattimo stays closer to the letter of Heidegger than do his French colleagues. If he analyzes Nietzsche in less detail he has stimulating interpretations to give of *The Use and Abuse of History*, the possibility of the *Übermensch*, Nietzsche's view of art, and the eternal recurrence. While Vattimo respectively interprets Heidegger and Nietzsche in thorough and scholarly fashion, sometimes he too readily conflates their thought. This, of course, is a risk that is as endemic to the Heidegger-Nietzsche movement as to any such coupling. A problem raised by one will be advanced, completed or countered by the other. For instance, the essay on "The Will to Power as Art" concludes with what may seem to some Heideggerians a radical claim: "The Heideggerian hope of a new epoch of being is probably to come about . . . through this act of radical disorganization of the subject that, for Nietzsche, exercises itself above all in the will to power as art" (p. 122). Nietzsche cannot be presented as an answer to a Heideggerian question without first showing that his answer fulfills the criteria raised by the question. In this case the ontological hope of Heidegger must be shown to be satisfied by the (ontological) consequences of Nietzsche's will to power as art. Vattimo here, as in one or two other essays, ends rather laconically, not having spelled out his own argument in quite the detail that he has the problematic. He warns us of this, however, stressing rightly that it is the problematic, and that it be well focused, that is important. He modestly admits that he is proposing only provisional answers, answers that point towards undiscovered terrain. And that they do. His essays are themselves adventures, though, it must be said, not of the frivolous sort that often characterizes work taking its lead from Nietzsche and Heidegger. Eloquent and instructive, *The Adventures of Difference* put us into a modern confrontation with some of the most central issues of the two Germans while soundly rejecting other, less studious confrontations.—T.H.